



XXXX Bank API Document

V 1.0

Authored By : Aditya Mishra





XXX Bank API Document

Document Version Detail

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Document Definition: This document describes XXX Bank API endpoints and their inherent functionalities.			
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1. Introduction

The Banking Transaction API provides a secure and standardized interface for managing banking operations, including account management, transaction processing, fund transfers, balance inquiries, beneficiary management, statement generation, and transaction monitoring.

The API is designed to support both retail and corporate banking applications by enabling real-time communication between banking channels and the core banking platform. It allows authorized applications to initiate financial transactions, retrieve account information, validate beneficiaries, generate statements, and track transaction status while maintaining strict security and compliance requirements.

The API follows REST principles and exchanges data using JSON payloads. All communications are secured using HTTPS and token-based authentication mechanisms.

2. Key Features

The Banking Transaction API provides the following capabilities:

- Account balance inquiry
- Transaction history retrieval
- Internal fund transfers
- External fund transfers
- Beneficiary management
- Deposit processing
- Withdrawal processing
- Transaction status tracking
- Account statement generation
- Customer account information retrieval
- Transaction reversal processing
- Audit and compliance tracking
- Real-time payment processing

3. Base URL

Production Environment

<https://api.xxxxxxbank.com/v1>

UAT Environment

<https://uat-api.xxxxxxbank.com/v1>



4. Authentication

All API requests require a valid access token. The Banking Transaction API uses JWT-based authentication. Clients must first authenticate with the Identity Provider and obtain an access token. The token must be included in the Authorization header of every API request.

Example Header

Authorization: Bearer eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIs...

5. Common Request Headers

Before invoking any Banking Transaction API, ensure that the required request headers are included. The following request headers enable secure communication, request validation, transaction tracking, and channel identification across the Banking Transaction API ecosystem. Headers marked as mandatory must be included in all API requests.

Header	Type	Required	Description
Authorization	String	Yes	JWT access token used to authenticate the client application.
Content-Type	String	Yes	Specifies the format of the request payload. Supported value: application/json.
Accept	String	Yes	Specifies the expected response format. Supported value: application/json.
X-Correlation-ID	String	No	Unique identifier used to trace a request across multiple systems and services.
X-Channel-ID	String	No	Identifies the channel from which the request originated, such as Mobile Banking, Internet Banking, ATM, or Branch Portal.
X-Client-ID	String	No	Unique identifier assigned to the consuming application.
X-Request-Timestamp	String	No	Timestamp indicating when the request was generated by the client application.
X-User-ID	String	No	Unique identifier of the authenticated user performing the transaction.

A. Sample Request Headers

Refer below example of a sample request header for Curl:

Authorization: Bearer eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR...
Content-Type: application/json
Accept: application/json
X-Correlation-ID: CORR-123456789
X-Channel-ID: MOBILE_BANKING
X-Client-ID: MB_APP_001
X-Request-Timestamp: 2026-01-02T10:30:00Z
X-User-ID: USER12345



B. Header Descriptions

Refer below descriptions of headers:

i) Authorization

Used to authenticate API requests. The token must be obtained from the bank's Identity Provider before invoking any protected endpoint.

ii)Content-Type

Indicates the format of the request payload. Banking APIs typically accept JSON-formatted requests.

iii) Accept

Defines the format expected in the response. Most banking APIs return responses in JSON format.

iv) X-Correlation-ID

Helps support teams and developers trace a request throughout the banking ecosystem. This value should be unique for every API invocation.

V) X-Channel-ID

Identifies the source channel initiating the request. This information is often used for auditing, analytics, and fraud monitoring.

Common Channel Values

Refer below detail of applicable channel values:

Value	Description
MOBILE_BANKING	Mobile banking application
INTERNET_BANKING	Web banking portal
ATM	ATM network
BRANCH	Branch banking application
API_PARTNER	Third-party partner integration
CALL_CENTER	Customer service application

C. Header Validation Failure Example

Below example illustrates an example of a scenario when header validation fails.

HTTP Status: 401 Unauthorized

```
{
  "timestamp": "2026-06-02T10:30:00Z",
  "errorCode": "UNAUTHORIZED",
  "message": "Authorization token is missing or invalid.",
  "correlationId": "CORR-123456789"
}
```



D. Missing Header Example

Below example demonstrate a scenario where header is missing.

HTTP Status: 400 Bad Request

```
{
  "timestamp": "2026-06-02T10:30:00Z",
  "errorCode": "MISSING_REQUIRED_HEADER",
  "message": "Content-Type header is required.",
  "correlationId": "CORR-123456789"
}
```

E. Notes

- All requests must be sent over HTTPS.
- JWT tokens should be refreshed before expiration.
- Correlation IDs should be unique for every request.
- Sensitive information must never be passed through custom headers.
- Header names are case-insensitive, but using the documented format is recommended for consistency.

This section can be reused as a common "Request Headers" chapter in your API document and referenced by all endpoints instead of repeating it for every API.

6. Account Management APIs

Account Management APIs provide access to customer account information and account balances. These endpoints are commonly used by mobile banking applications, internet banking portals, ATM systems, and customer service applications to retrieve account-related information in real time.

6.1 Retrieve Account Details

Endpoint

```
GET /accounts/{accountNumber}
```

This API retrieves comprehensive account information associated with a specified account number. The endpoint is commonly used by mobile banking applications, customer service portals, and internal banking systems to display customer account information.

The response includes account status, account type, branch information, customer details, currency, and account opening date.



Path Parameters

The following path parameter is required to identify the account for which information is being requested.

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
accountNumber	String	Yes	Unique account number assigned by the bank

Success Response

The following example shows a JSON successful response returned by the API after the account details have been retrieved successfully.

```
{
  "accountNumber": "1234567890",
  "accountType": "Savings",
  "customerName": "John Smith",
  "branchCode": "BR1001",
  "currency": "INR",
  "status": "ACTIVE",
  "openedDate": "2020-01-15"
}
```

Success Response Parameter

Below are the fields returned in the successful response.

Parameter	Type	Description
accountNumber	String	Unique bank account number.
accountType	String	Type of account such as Savings or Current.
customerName	String	Full name of the account holder.
branchCode	String	Unique code of the branch maintaining the account.
currency	String	ISO currency code associated with the account.
status	String	Current account status (ACTIVE, DORMANT, CLOSED, BLOCKED).
openedDate	Date	Date on which the account was opened.

Failure Response

Below example demonstrate a scenario where system returns failure response.

HTTP Status: 404 Not Found

```
{
  "errorCode": "ACCOUNT_NOT_FOUND",
  "message": "No account found for account number 1234567890."
}
```



6.2 Account Balance Inquiry

Endpoint

GET /accounts/{accountNumber}/balance

Description

This endpoint retrieves the current available balance, ledger balance, and hold amount for a specified account. The API is frequently invoked during payment initiation, fund transfer validation, ATM withdrawals, and account overview screens.

The available balance represents the amount that can be immediately used by the customer, while the ledger balance includes pending transactions.

Path Parameters

The following path parameter is required to get the account balance for the account which information is being requested.

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
account Number	String	Yes	Bank account number

Success Response

The following JSON example shows a successful response returned by the API after account balance is returned.

```
{
  "accountNumber": "1234567890",
  "currency": "INR",
  "availableBalance": 45000.00,
  "ledgerBalance": 47000.00,
  "holdAmount": 2000.00
}
```

Success Response Parameters

The system returns below parameter fields in case of success.

Parameter	Type	Description
accountNumber	String	Unique account number.
currency	String	Currency associated with the account.
availableBalance	Decimal	Amount available for immediate withdrawal or transfer.
ledgerBalance	Decimal	Total balance including pending transactions.
holdAmount	Decimal	Funds temporarily unavailable due to holds or pending transactions.



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Failure Response

Below is the sample failure response.

```
{  
  "errorCode": "ACCOUNT_BLOCKED",  
  "message": "Balance inquiry is not permitted for this account."  
}
```



7. Transaction Processing APIs

7.1 Create Transaction

Endpoint

POST /transactions

Description

This API initiates a banking transaction between one or more accounts. Depending on the transaction type, the system validates account ownership, account status, balance sufficiency, transaction limits, fraud controls, and compliance rules before processing the transaction.

Upon successful processing, a unique transaction identifier is generated and returned to the client application.

Request Body

Refer below JSON request example to create a transaction.

```
{
  "transactionType": "TRANSFER",
  "amount": 5000,
  "currency": "INR",
  "fromAccount": "1234567890",
  "toAccount": "9876543210",
  "remarks": "Monthly Rent"
}
```

Request Parameters

Below fields are included in the request body/payload.

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
transactionType	String	Yes	DEPOSIT, WITHDRAWAL, TRANSFER
amount	Decimal	Yes	Transaction amount
currency	String	Yes	ISO currency code
fromAccount	String	Yes	Source account
toAccount	String	Yes	Destination account
remarks	String	No	Additional notes



Success Response

Below is example of a success in JSON:

```
{
  "transactionId": "TXN10056789",
  "status": "SUCCESS",
  "transactionDate": "2026-05-20T10:45:30Z"
}
```

Success Response Parameters

Below fields get returned in a success response:

Parameter	Type	Description
transactionId	String	Unique identifier generated for the transaction.
status	String	Current transaction status.
transactionDate	DateTime	Date and time when the transaction was processed.

Failure Response

Below example demonstrate a scenario where system returns failure response.

HTTP Status: 400 Bad Request

```
{
  "errorCode": "INSUFFICIENT_FUNDS",
  "message": "Available balance is insufficient."
}
```

Business Rules

- Amount must be greater than zero.
- Source account must be active.
- Daily transaction limit must not be exceeded.
- Currency must be supported by the bank.



7.2 Get Transaction Details

Endpoint

GET /transactions/{transactionId}

Description

This endpoint retrieves complete details of a specific banking transaction. It is typically used for transaction tracking, dispute investigation, customer support inquiries, and audit activities.

The response includes transaction status, transaction amount, source account, destination account, processing timestamp, and reference information.

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
transactionId	String	Yes	Unique transaction identifier

Success Response

Refer below sample success response in JSON.

{ "transactionId": "TXN10056789", "amount": 5000, "status": "SUCCESS", "currency": "INR", "fromAccount": "1234567890", "toAccount": "9876543210", "transactionDate": "2026-05-20T10:45:30Z" }

Response Parameters

Below fields returns in a success response:

Parameter	Type	Description
transactionId	String	Unique transaction reference number.
amount	Decimal	Amount processed in the transaction.
status	String	Current transaction status.
currency	String	Currency used for the transaction.
fromAccount	String	Source account from which funds were debited.
toAccount	String	Destination account that received the funds.
transactionDate	DateTime	Date and time of transaction processing.



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Failure Response

Refer below sample failure response in JSON.

```
{  
  "errorCode": "TRANSACTION_NOT_FOUND",  
  "message": "The specified transaction could not be located."  
}
```



7.3 Retrieve Transaction History

Endpoint

GET /accounts/{accountNumber}/transactions

Description

Retrieves transaction history for a specified account within a configurable date range. This endpoint supports pagination to efficiently handle large transaction volumes.

Common use cases include account statement views, transaction searches, financial reporting, and reconciliation processes.

Request/Query Parameters

Below is the detail of request parameters. It includes both mandatory and optional fields.

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
fromDate	Date	Yes	Beginning of date range
toDate	Date	Yes	End of date range
page	Integer	No	Page number
pageSize	Integer	No	Records per page

Success Response

Below is sample success response.

```
{
  "accountNumber": "1234567890",
  "page": 1,
  "pageSize": 2,
  "totalRecords": 25,
  "transactions": [
    {
      "transactionId": "TXN001",
      "amount": 1000,
      "type": "DEPOSIT"
    }
  ]
}
```



Response Parameters

System returns below fields in a success response.

Parameter	Type	Description
accountNumber	String	Account for which history is being retrieved.
page	Integer	Current page number.
pageSize	Integer	Number of records returned per page.
totalRecords	Integer	Total transaction records available.
transactions	Array	List of transaction records.

Failure Response

Refer below failure response example that returns if provided date range is invalid.

```
{
  "errorCode": "INVALID_DATE_RANGE",
  "message": "fromDate cannot be later than toDate."
}
```



8. Fund Transfer APIs

8.1 Internal Fund Transfer

Endpoint

POST /transfers/internal

Description

Facilitates transfers between accounts maintained within the same banking institution. The API performs account validation, balance checks, limit verification, and real-time posting.

Internal transfers are generally processed instantly.

Request Body

Refer a sample Request Body:

```
{
  "fromAccount": "1234567890",
  "toAccount": "1111222233",
  "amount": 2500,
  "currency": "INR",
  "remarks": "Family Transfer"
}
```

Request Parameters

Below fields are included in a request parameter.

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
fromAccount	String	Yes	Source account
toAccount	String	Yes	Destination account
amount	Decimal	Yes	Transfer amount
currency	String	Yes	Currency code
remarks	String	No	Transfer remarks

Success Response

Below is a sample success response.

```
{
  "transferId": "IFT123456",
  "status": "SUCCESS",
}
```




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```
"amount": 2500
}
```

Response Parameters

System returns below fields in a success response:

Parameter	Type	Description
transferId	String	Unique internal transfer reference number.
status	String	Processing status of the transfer.
amount	Decimal	Amount transferred.
transferDate	DateTime	Date and time when the transfer was completed.

Failure Response

Below example demonstrate a scenario where system returns failure response in case daily limit validation failed.

```
{
  "errorCode": "DAILY_LIMIT_EXCEEDED",
  "message": "The daily transfer limit has been exceeded."
}
```

8.2 External Fund Transfer

Endpoint

POST /transfers/external

Description

Initiates fund transfers to accounts maintained at other financial institutions through payment networks such as NEFT, RTGS, IMPS, ACH, or SWIFT.

Additional validations are performed to ensure beneficiary verification and regulatory compliance.

Request

Below is a sample request body.

```
{
  "fromAccount": "1234567890",
  "beneficiaryId": "BEN10001",
  "transferType": "NEFT",
}
```



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```
"amount": 15000,  
"remarks": "Vendor Payment"  
}
```

Request Parameters

Refer below sample request parameters.

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
fromAccount	String	Yes	Sender account
beneficiaryId	String	Yes	Registered beneficiary
transferType	String	Yes	NEFT, RTGS, IMPS, SWIFT
amount	Decimal	Yes	Transfer amount
remarks	String	No	Payment description

Success Response

```
{  
  "referenceNumber": "NEFT456789",  
  "status": "PROCESSING",  
  "amount": 15000  
}
```

Response Parameters

Parameter	Type	Description
referenceNumber	String	Unique payment network reference number.
status	String	Current transfer status.
amount	Decimal	Amount transferred.

Failure Response

Below example demonstrate a scenario where system returns failure response.

```
{  
  "errorCode": "BENEFICIARY_NOT_FOUND",  
  "message": "The specified beneficiary does not exist."  
}
```



9. Beneficiary Management APIs

9.1 Add Beneficiary

Endpoint

POST /beneficiaries

Description

Creates a new beneficiary record for future fund transfers. Beneficiaries may represent individuals, vendors, merchants, or corporate accounts.

The API validates account details and stores beneficiary information after successful verification.

Request

```
{
  "beneficiaryName": "Aditya Mishra",
  "accountNumber": "9876543210",
  "ifscCode": "SBIN0001234",
  "bankName": "State Bank"
}
```

Request Parameters

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
beneficiaryName	String	Yes	Beneficiary full name
accountNumber	String	Yes	Beneficiary account
ifscCode	String	Yes	Bank IFSC code
bankName	String	Yes	Bank name

Success Response

```
{
  "beneficiaryId": "BEN10001",
  "status": "ACTIVE"
}
```



Response Parameters

Below are parameter returned by system in case of success.

Parameter	Type	Description
customerId	String	Unique customer identifier.
beneficiaries	Array	List of registered beneficiaries.

Failure Response

Below example demonstrate a scenario where system returns failure response in case IFSC code validation failed.

```
{
  "errorCode": "INVALID_IFSC",
  "message": "The IFSC code provided is invalid."
}
```

9.2 Retrieve Beneficiary List

Endpoint

GET /beneficiaries

Description

Returns all beneficiaries associated with the authenticated customer profile.

Path Parameters

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
Beneficiary Name	Varchar	Yes	Unique account number assigned by the bank



10. Statement APIs

10.1 Generate Account Statement

Endpoint

POST /statements

Description

Generates a detailed account statement for a specified period. The generated statement may be downloaded in PDF, CSV, or Excel formats depending on business requirements.

The statement contains debit transactions, credit transactions, opening balance, closing balance, and running balance information.

Request Body

Refer below sample request body payload with required parameters and data.

```
{
  "accountNumber": "1234567890",
  "fromDate": "2026-01-01",
  "toDate": "2026-01-31",
  "format": "PDF"
}
```

Request Parameter

Below fields are included in the request parameter:

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
accountNumber	String	Yes	Account number
fromDate	Date	Yes	Start date
toDate	Date	Yes	End date
format	String	Yes	PDF, CSV, XLSX

Success Response

Below example shows a success response.

```
{
  "statementId": "STM10001",
  "downloadUrl": "/statements/STM10001/download",
}
```



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```
"status": "GENERATED"
}
```

Response Parameters

Below field returns in a success response.

Parameter	Type	Description
statementId	String	Unique statement generation request ID.
downloadUrl	String	URL used to download the generated statement.
status	String	Current statement generation status.

Failure Response

Refer below failure response.

```
{
  "errorCode": "INVALID_DATE_RANGE",
  "message": "Statement date range exceeds allowed limits."
}
```



11. Transaction Reversal API

11.1 Reverse Transaction

Endpoint

POST /transactions/{transactionId}/reverse

Description

Reverses a previously completed transaction under authorized circumstances such as duplicate processing, operational errors, or dispute resolution.

Only eligible transactions can be reversed. All reversal requests are recorded for audit and compliance purposes.

Success Response

```
{
  "transactionId": "TXN10056789",
  "reversalId": "REV10001",
  "status": "REVERSED"
}
```

Response Parameters

Parameter	Type	Description
transactionId	String	Original transaction being reversed.
reversalId	String	Unique reversal transaction identifier.
status	String	Current reversal status.

Failure Response

```
{
  "errorCode": "REVERSAL_NOT_ALLOWED",
  "message": "The transaction is not eligible for reversal."
}
```



12. Transaction Status API

12.1 Check Transaction Status

Endpoint

GET /transactions/{transactionId}/status

Description

Returns the current processing status of a transaction.

Success Response

Refer below success response in case of successful validation of the API request.

```
{
  "transactionId": "TXN10056789",
  "status": "SUCCESS",
  "lastUpdated": "2026-05-20T10:50:00Z"
}
```

Response Parameters

A successful response includes below field.

Parameter	Type	Description
transactionId	String	Unique transaction reference.
status	String	Current state of the transaction.
lastUpdated	DateTime	Last timestamp when transaction status changed.

Failure Response

```
{
  "errorCode": "TRANSACTION_NOT_FOUND",
  "message": "Unable to locate transaction."
}
```

Possible statuses include:

Status	Description
PENDING	Awaiting processing
PROCESSING	In progress
SUCCESS	Completed successfully



FAILED	Processing failed
REVERSED	Reversed transaction
CANCELLED	Cancelled by user/system

13. Audit APIs

13.1 Retrieve Audit Logs

Endpoint

GET /audit/transactions

Description

Provides transaction audit records for compliance, regulatory reporting, and forensic investigations. The endpoint allows authorized users to review transaction activities, user actions, timestamps, and system-generated events.

Query Parameters

Parameter	Type	Required	Description
fromDate	Date	No	Start date
toDate	Date	No	End date
userId	String	No	User identifier

Success Response

{ "auditRecords": [{ "eventType": "TRANSFER", "performedBy": "USER123", "timestamp": "2026-05-20T10:30:00Z" }] }
--

Response Parameters

Parameter	Type	Description
auditRecords	Array	Collection of audit events returned by the system.
eventType	String	Type of activity performed.
performedBy	String	User or system responsible for the action.
timestamp	DateTime	Date and time when the event occurred.



Common Audit Event Types

Event Type	Description
LOGIN	User login activity
LOGOUT	User logout activity
TRANSFER	Fund transfer activity
BENEFICIARY_CREATE	Beneficiary creation
STATEMENT_DOWNLOAD	Statement generation or download
ACCOUNT_UPDATE	Account modification activity

This level of response documentation is what reviewers typically expect in enterprise API specifications because it removes ambiguity and allows developers to understand the response structure without inspecting the JSON example alone.

14. Error Handling

Standard Error Response

```
{
  "timestamp": "2026-05-20T10:30:00Z",
  "errorCode": "INSUFFICIENT_FUNDS",
  "message": "Available balance is insufficient.",
  "correlationId": "123456789"
}
```

Error Codes

Code	Description
INVALID_REQUEST	Request validation failed
ACCOUNT_NOT_FOUND	Account does not exist
BENEFICIARY_NOT_FOUND	Beneficiary not found
INSUFFICIENT_FUNDS	Available balance insufficient
DAILY_LIMIT_EXCEEDED	Daily transfer limit exceeded
TRANSACTION_NOT_FOUND	Invalid transaction ID
UNAUTHORIZED	Authentication failure
FORBIDDEN	Insufficient permissions
INTERNAL_SERVER_ERROR	Unexpected system error



15. Security and Compliance

The Banking Transaction API complies with industry security standards and banking regulations.

Security controls include:

- TLS 1.2+ encryption
- OAuth 2.0 / JWT authentication
- Multi-factor authentication support
- Role-Based Access Control (RBAC)
- Transaction signing
- Audit logging
- Fraud monitoring integration
- PCI-DSS compliance controls
- Data encryption at rest
- API rate limiting and throttling

16. API Versioning

The Banking Transaction API uses URI-based versioning.

/v1/accounts
/v1/transactions
/v1/transfers

Future enhancements and breaking changes will be introduced through newer API versions while maintaining backward compatibility whenever possible.



17. Glossary

The following glossary defines key technical, banking, and API-related terms used throughout this document.

Term	Definition
API	Application Programming Interface. A set of rules and protocols that allows applications to communicate with each other.
Access Token	A security credential used to authenticate and authorize API requests.
AES-256	Advanced Encryption Standard with a 256-bit key length used for secure data encryption.
Authentication	The process of verifying the identity of a user, system, or application.
Authorization	The process of determining whether an authenticated user or application has permission to access a resource.
Beneficiary	An individual or organization authorized to receive funds from an account holder.
Correlation ID	A unique identifier used to track and trace API requests across multiple systems.
Currency Code	A standardized three-letter code representing a currency, such as INR, USD, or EUR.
DBMS	Database Management System used to store and manage application data.
Endpoint	A specific URL exposed by an API to perform a particular operation.
Fund Transfer	The movement of money from one account to another.
HTTP	Hypertext Transfer Protocol used for communication between clients and servers.
HTTPS	Secure version of HTTP that encrypts data exchanged between systems.
IFSC Code	Indian Financial System Code used to uniquely identify a bank branch in India.
IMPS	Immediate Payment Service, a real-time interbank electronic fund transfer system in India.
JSON	JavaScript Object Notation, a lightweight data-interchange format used for API communication.
JWT	JSON Web Token used for securely transmitting authentication and authorization information.
Ledger Balance	The total balance in an account, including pending transactions that may not yet be available for use.
NEFT	National Electronic Funds Transfer, an electronic payment system used for transferring funds between banks in India.
OAuth 2.0	An industry-standard authorization framework that allows secure access to protected resources.
Pagination	A technique used to divide large result sets into smaller, manageable pages.
Path Parameter	A value included in the API URL path that identifies a specific resource.



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Query Parameter	A parameter appended to a URL that modifies or filters the API response.
Request Body	The data payload sent by a client to an API during POST, PUT, or PATCH operations.
Response Body	The data returned by the API after processing a request.
REST API	Representational State Transfer API, an architectural style for building web services using HTTP methods.
RTGS	Real-Time Gross Settlement, a high-value electronic funds transfer system.
SFTP	Secure File Transfer Protocol used to securely transfer files between systems.
SQL	Structured Query Language used for managing and querying relational databases.
Statement	A detailed record of account transactions for a specified period.
Status Code	A standardized HTTP code indicating the outcome of an API request.
Transaction ID	A unique identifier assigned to a banking transaction.
TLS	Transport Layer Security protocol used to secure network communications.
URI	Uniform Resource Identifier used to identify API resources.
Validation	The process of verifying that input data meets defined business and technical rules.
Web Service	A software component that enables communication between applications over a network.
X-Channel-ID	A custom header used to identify the source channel initiating an API request.
X-Correlation-ID	A custom header used for request tracing and troubleshooting across distributed systems.